

Introduction to Technical Writing

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Reflecting on...

- Do you think communication skills are of minor importance in scientific and technical studies?
- Do you think a technical student can write as well as a humanities student?
- What characteristics do you think distinguish a technical text from a non-technical one?
- How can your knowledge of general purpose English help you towards writing technical documents?
- Why is it important to study technical and professional communication?
- Why write a letter or a memo if you can make a quick phone call?
- Why spend time thinking about how to put into words information that can be transmitted spontaneously without the extra effort of heeding syntax and punctuation?

What is Technical Writing?

- Technical writing is a form of technical communication used in a variety of technical and occupational fields, such as computer hardware and software, engineering, chemistry, aeronautics and astronautics, robotics, finance, consumer electronics, and biotechnology.
- Technical writing, which must be understood easily and quickly includes;
 - Memos and e-mail
 - Letters
 - Reports
 - Instructions
 - Brochures
 - Newsletters
 - Web pages
 - Fliers
 - Resume
 - Curriculum Vitae

Importance of Technical Writing

- Customer-client relations
- Completion of the works as per the schedule
- Regular maintenance of the machineries
- Total quality management

The 3 C's of Good Technical Writing

- Clear
- Concise
- Complete

How is Technical Writing different?

- The information is organized, presented and communicated in a specific format.
- The writing is concise, clear and accurate.

- The writing takes into account the audience's needs, biases and prior understanding.
- The writing presents information to help readers solve a problem or gain a better understanding of a situation.
- The writing conveys technical, complex, or specialized information in a way that is easy for a non-technical reader to understand.

Various Activities a Technical Writer Involves in –

The role of a technical communicator involves:

- Project planning and project management
- Research into user and business needs
- Designing and (if applicable) prototyping
- Interviewing and observing people at their work
- Gathering information from a range of other sources - existing documentation, specifications, and experts

- Recording and organizing the information gathered
- Developing the information product
- Updating and correcting draft versions of the information product following reviews by users and content providers
- Testing the information product for functionality and usability
- Publishing or delivering the information product
- Periodically updating the information product to ensure that it remains relevant, complete and correct.

Deliverables

Forms of technical content created by technical writers, includes;

- Scientific reports
- Specifications
- Technical papers
- Online Help
- Training materials

- Troubleshooting guides
- Installation guides
- User guides
- Programmers' guides
- White papers
- Network administrators' guides
- Network configuration guides
- Policies and procedures
- Presentations
- Proposals
- Reference documents
- Release notes
- Reports
- Requirements documentation
- Corporate Annual Reports

- Corporate disclaimers
- Feature Design Documentation
- Magazine articles
- Site preparation guides
- Journal or Research Articles
- Social Media
- Network recovery guides & Etc.

Conclusion

- In many different types of work, writing constitutes an important part of the everyday workload.
- They facilitate communication with co-workers, clients and supervisors, that is, inside and outside the workplace.
- They are necessary for a successful career.
- Writing skills contribute to saving time and money.

Thank
you

A 3D illustration of the words "Thank you" in a playful, blocky font. The letters are blue with yellow outlines and are mounted on yellow rectangular blocks. The words are arranged in two lines: "Thank" on top and "you" below it. The entire scene is set against a solid pink background. Scattered around the text are several colorful stars in shades of blue, yellow, and purple, each with a red shadow underneath, giving the impression of stars falling or floating.